

The Heart of Noble Dependent Origination

Ārya Pratītyasamutpāda Hṛdaya Nāma · Toh 521 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྟེན་ཅི་འབྲེ་པར་འབད་བའ་སྟོན་པ་ཞེས་བུ

The Heart of Noble Dependent Origination, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Pratītyasamutpāda Hṛdaya and in Tibetan as Phags pa rten cing 'brel par 'byung ba'i snying po, is a brief Mahāyāna sūtra centered on the doctrine of dependent origination, one of the Buddha's most fundamental teachings. The text presents the celebrated verse — "Those phenomena that arise from causes, their causes, and the cessation of those causes: thus has the Tathāgata declared" — which encapsulates the entire teaching of conditioned arising and is traditionally considered a potent distillation of the Dharma. Alongside the verse in both translation and original Sanskrit, the text attributes great purificatory and protective power to its recitation, positioning it as a kind of dhāraṇī-like heart essence. It is Toh 521 in the Kangyur, classified among the Mahāyāna sūtras.

They offered praise for what the Blessed One had declared. This completes the noble sūtra of the Great Vehicle entitled "Dependent Origination."

In the language of India: Ārya Pratītyasamutpāda Hṛdaya Nāma. In the Tibetan language: "The Heart of Noble Dependent Origination."

Homage to the Buddha, the Blessed One.

Those phenomena that arise from causes —
their causes, and the cessation of those causes:
thus has the Tathāgata declared.

The great renunciant (śramaṇa) has spoken thus.

Ye dharmā hetuprabhavā hetun teṣāṃ tathāgato hy avadat, teṣāṃ ca yo nirodha evaṃ vādī mahāśramaṇaḥ.

By reciting this heart-essence even once, all misdeeds will be purified. All adverse conditions will be pacified and turned back. If one recites it while directing one's mind toward any particular thing, it will become endowed with the qualities of a buddha's

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, indicating this is an incomplete passage. The final sentence beginning "If one recites it while directing one's mind toward any particular thing, it will become endowed with the qualities of a buddha's..." trails off, and the continuation

is not present in the supplied Tibetan.

The Sanskrit verse "Ye dharmā hetuprabhavā..." is the famous Pratītyasamutpāda formula found throughout the Tibetan canon; it is reproduced here in its Sanskrit form as it appears in the original text, with the Tibetan verse serving as its translation. The rendering of the Tibetan verse follows the standard interpretation of this formula.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.